

CHOOSING YOUR BATTLES WISELY

Lead Verses

1. Luke 14:28-30, 14:31-32

New International Version

28 "Suppose one of you wants to build a tower. Won't you first sit down and estimate the cost to see if you have enough money to complete it? 29 For if you lay the foundation and are not able to finish it, everyone who sees it will ridicule you, 30 saying, 'This person began to build and wasn't able to finish.'

2. Luke 14:31-32 New International Version

31 "Or suppose a king is about to go to war against another king. Won't he first sit down and consider whether he is able with ten thousand men to oppose the one coming against him with twenty thousand? 32 If he is not able, he will send a delegation while the other is still a long way off and will ask for terms of peace.

A believer must be like a driver who embarks on a long-distance journey. He always carries a spare tire with him somewhere at the back of his car where ever he goes and at all the time.

Not because he wishes to suffer a tyre burst, a puncture or a break-down but because he is alive to the fact that these are events that are bound to happen

He knows that the road will at some point get rough, bumpy and tough. He also knows that he will not be

the only user of the road and that some times he might be forced to drive on the edges of the road, run through pot-holes to save himself, others and as well as in order to reach his destination safe and alive

At the start of the journey, he prepares himself for the destination. Whatever happens on the way, he treats as 'bound to happen' and he wants to put it all behind him as quickly as possible and move on

He chooses not to divert his attention for he knows that a man with divided attention is a *man without attention* and is like a lion who chases without a target. This is what apostle James teaches in the first chapter of his book verses 8 and 7

His focus remains intact no matter the events that happen on the way.

He is a man full of hope. He is optimistic that eventually he will reach his destination. This is why he does not bother to carry with him four tyres as spares. He hopes for minimal challenges and a bigger success probability. This is what our Lord Jesus Christ told in Matthew 10:23 (*But when they persecute you in this city, flee into the next: for verily I say unto you, Ye shall not have gone through the cities of Israel, till the Son of man be come.*)

From the beginning of his journey, he knows that there is only one important battle worthy taking on, the battle against anything that blocks the path ahead of him.

He commits all his time, effort and resources to ensuring that he arrives to his destination

This is how a believer must be. For the path of the one who believes is not smooth. It is bumpy, full of distractors, nay sayers, discouraging events and people who are only there to steal away your focus. Apostle Paul told this in Philippians 3:13-14 (*Brothers, I do not consider that I have made it my own. But one thing I do: forgetting what lies behind and straining forward to what lies ahead, I press on toward the goal for the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus.*)

In Matthew 10:22 Jesus told the disciples "You will be hated by everyone because of me, but the one who stands firm to the end will be saved."

Jesus our Lord told us what to do when we are obstructed or even distracted, Matthew 10:23

New International Version

23 When you are persecuted in one place, flee to another. Truly I tell you, you will not finish going through the towns of Israel before the Son of Man comes.

Do not be delayed or distracted by those who wait by the road side to mock you with words, name calling, to write you off, dare you and all alike. God has already taken care of them. This is what David writes in Psalms; Psalm 34:19

New International Version

19 The righteous person may have many troubles, but the Lord delivers him from them all;

Do not be held hostage by circumstances and emerging events that pops on your journey of faith. They are un necessary battle to take. They will only

serve to drain off your energy, steal away your time and delay you from the fulfilment of God's plan for you. Keep moving!

In **Matthew 10:16** Jesus told the disciples that he was sending them like sheep among wolves and they must be as wise as snake and as innocent as doves. If you read through to **verse 17&18** you see a list of encounters you must come across yet Jesus promised "I will be with you"

When David visited his brothers at the valley of Elah (**1Samuel 17**) he did not in any way intent to participate in the contest of war (**even when he knew he could possibly fight successfully**) until he heard of the offer that the King had placed on the table for any one who will fight and kill Goliath, (**read verse 25**). Because David was a clever and responsible warrior, he offered to fight Goliath for the price that the king had put on the table

Initially David had a mis understanding with his brother, Elias (**verse 29**) but this was a battle not worth taking for him

In **verses 33-37** he told the king he had made up his mind to take on Goliath for the prize put on the table

When Nehemiah undertook to rebuild the wall of Jericho (**Nehemiah 4**), Sanballat and Tobiah tried to stop him with negative talks, ridicule and mockery but Nehemiah chose to ignore them. The wall stood completely in less than number of days anticipated and the beauty of the city was restored